

SPINELESS YUCCA

Yucca elephantipes

The yucca adds a refreshing pop of green and is a very easygoing house guest. It's hardy, tolerant of most places apart from a very chilly conservatory, and doesn't demand much! Its architectural trunk and palmlike leaves will be a bold, exotic presence in your home.

“I will transport you to a tropical paradise.”

Help me thrive



POSITION

Loves full sun but will tolerate light shade, although this will slow its growth and lighten the leaves. Turn occasionally so every part gets the sun.



POTTING

Doesn't often require repotting as it likes crowded roots, but if roots grow out of the drainage holes, repot in the spring using a loam-based compost.



GROWTH RATE

This slow-growing plant generally reaches 3¼ft (1m) tall and 1ft (30cm) wide after 5 years, although it can ultimately reach 6ft (1.8m).



CARE

Water moderately in the summer, waiting until the top 2in (5cm) of soil has dried out in between waterings. Water only sparingly in winter.



Bathe in my tropical beauty

My thick, woody stem and angular, swordlike foliage make a bold statement in a modern scheme without taking up too much floor space. And because I look like a miniature palm tree, you can take a tropical forest bath in my presence, helping you drift off to an island paradise.

My bell flowers grow on spikes that shoot from my crown



Let's make babies

You can grow my family in spring, either by repotting new offsets that appear from my trunk or by taking cuttings from my mature growth. Take a cutting of at least 3in (8cm) and remove all but the top leaves, then add some rooting hormone to the base and repot it.

Water the baby when the top of the soil dries out.